

The

Conuertyon of Swe-

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Conuertyon of Swe-
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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE
CONUERCYON OF SWERERS ***

This e-text includes characters that will only display in UTF-8 (Unicode) file encoding:

ãẽĩõũỹ (vowel with “tilde” or overline for following m/n)

If any of these characters do not display properly—in particular, if the diacritic does not appear directly above the letter—or if the apostrophes and

quotation marks in this paragraph appear as garbage, you may have an incompatible browser or unavailable fonts. First, make sure that the browser's "character set" or "file encoding" is set to Unicode (UTF-8). You may also need to change your browser's default font.

All folio numbers except A.iii. were added by the transcriber. Verso pages are shown as ||.

Spelling and punctuation are unchanged unless otherwise noted. Possible errors are shown with mouse-hover popups. Further notes, and a thumbnail view of page A.iii.verso, are at the [end of the text](#).



He frutefull sentēce & the noble werkes
To our doctryne wrytē ī olde ātyquyte
By many gret & ryght notable clerkes
Groūded on reason and hygh auctoryte

Dyde gyue vs example by good moralyte
To folowe the trace of trouth and ryght wysnes
Leuyngē our synne and mortall wrechednes

By theyr wrytyngē doth to vs appere
The famous actes of many a champyon
In the courte of fame renowned fayre and clere
And some endyted theyr entencyon
Clokēd in coloure harde in construccyon
Specyally poetes vnder cloudy fygyres
Couered the trouthe of all theyr scryptures

So hystoryagraphes all the worthy dedes
Of kynges and knyghtes dyde put in wrytyngē
To be in mende for theyr memoryall medes
How sholde we now haue knowledgyngē
Of thynges past / but by theyr endytyngē
Wherfore we ought to prayse them doubteles
That spent theyr tyme in suche good busynes.

Amonge all other my good mayster Lydgate

The eloquent poete and monke of bury
Dyde bothe contryue and also translate
Many vertues bokes to be in memory
Touchynge the trouthe well and sentencyously
But syth that his deth was intollerable
I praye god rewarde hym in lyfe perdurable

Amonge all thynges nothyng so prouffitable
As is scyence with the sentencyous scrypture
For worldly rychesse is often transmutable
As dayly dothe appere well in vre
Pet scyens a bydeth and is moost sure
After pouerte to attayne grete rychesse
Scyens is cause of promocion doubtles

I lytell or nought expert in poetrye
Remembrynge my youth so lyght and frayle
Purpose to compyle here full breuyatly
A lytell treatyse wofull to bewayle
The cruell swerers which do god assayle
On euery syde his swete body to tere
With terryble othes as often as they swere

But all for drede plunged in neclygence
My penne dothe quake to presume to endyte
But hope at laste to recure this scyence
Exorteth me ryght hardely to wryte
To deuoyde ydlenesse by good appetyte
For ydlenesse the grete moder of synne
Euery vyce is redy to lette ynne

I with the same ryght gretely infecte
Lykely to deye tyll grace by medecyne
Recured my sekenes my payne to abiecte
Commaundyng me by her hye power deuyne
To drawe this treatyse for to enlumyne
The reders therof by penytencyall pyte

And to pardon me of theyr benygnyte



Yght myghty prynces of euery crysten regyō
I sende you gretynge moche hertly & grace
Right wel to gouern vpright your dominiō
And all your lordes I greete in lyke cace

By this my lettre your hertes to embrace
Besechynge you to prynte it in your mynde
How for your sake I toke on me mankynde

And as a lambe moost mekely dyde enclyne
To suffre the dethe for your redempcyon
And ye my kynges whiche do nowe domyne
Ouer my comons in terrestriall mancyon
By pryncely preemynence and Iuredyccyon
In your regall courtes do suffre me be rente
And my tender body with blode all besprente

Without my grace ye maye nothyng preuayle
Though ye be kynges for to mayntene your see
To be a kynge it may nothyng auayle
Buy yf my grace preserue his dygnyte
Beholde your seruauntes how they do tere me
By cruell othes now vpon euery syde
About the worlde launcynge my woundes wyde

All the graces whiche I haue you shewed
Reuoule in mynde ryght ofte ententyfly
Beholde my body with bloody droppes endewed
Within your realmes nowe torne so pyteously
Towsed and tugged with othes cruelly
Some my heed some myn armes and face
Some my herte do all to rente and race

They newe agayne do hange me on the rode
They tere my sydes and are nothyng dysmayde
My woundes they open and deuoure my blode

I god and man moost woefully arayde
To you complayne it maye not be denayde
Ye nowe do tug me / ye tere me at the roote
Yet I to you am chefe refuyte and boote

Wherefore ye kynges reygnyng in renowne
Refourme your seruauntes in your courte abused
To good example of euery maner towne
So that theyr othes whiche they longe haue vsed
On payne and punysshement be holly refused
Meke as a Lambe I suffre theyr grete wronge
I maye take vengeaunce thoughe I tary longe

I do forbere I wolde haue you amende
And graunte you mercy and ye wyll it take
O my swete brederne why do ye offende
Agayne to tere me whiche deyed for your sake
Lo se my kyndenes and frome synne awake
I dyde redeme you from the deuylls chayne
And spyte of me ye wyll to hym agayne

Made I not heuen the moost glorious mansyon
In whiche I wolde be gladde to haue you in
Now come swete bretherne to myn habytacyon
Alas good brederne with your mortall synne
Why flee ye from me / to torne agayne begynne
I wrought you I bought you ye can it not denye
Yet to the deuyll ye go nowe wyllingly



☞ See

Me (kynde

Be ☞

☞ Agayne

My payne (in mynde

Reteayne



¶ My swete bloode
On the roode (my broder
Dyde the good ✿
¶ My face ryght red
Myn armes spred (thynke none oder
My woundes bled ✿ ✿
¶ Beholde thou my syde ✿
Wounded so ryght wyde (all for thyn owne sake
Bledynge sore that tyde

¶ Thus for the I smerted
Why arte þ^{ou} harde herted (& thy swerynge aslake
Be by me conuerted ✿

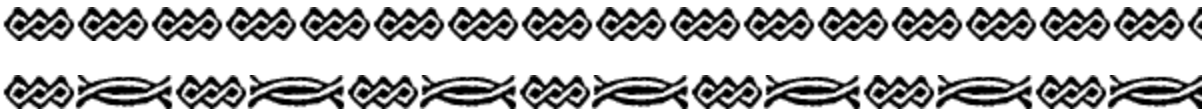
¶ Tere me nowe no more
My woundes are sore (and come to my grace
Leue swerynge therfore

¶ I am redy ✿
To graunte mercy (for thy trespass
To the truely

¶ Come nowe nere
My frende dere (before me
And appere ✿

¶ I so ✿
In wo (se se
Dyde go

¶ I ✿
Crye (the
Hy



Vnto me dere broder my loue and my herte
Turmente me no more with thyn othes grete
Come vnto my Ioye and agayne reuerte
From the deuylls snare and his sutyl net
Beware of the worlde all aboute the set

Thy flesshe is redy by concupyscence
To burne thy herte with cursed vyolence

Thoughe these thre enmyes do sore the assayle
Vpon euery syde with daungerous iniquite
But yf thou lyst / they may nothyng preuayle
Nor yet subdue the with all theyr extremyte
To do good or yll / all is at thy lyberte
I do graunte the grace thyn enemyes to subdue
Swete broder accepte it theyr power to extue

And ye kynges and prynces of hye noblenes
With dukes and lordes of euery dygnyte
Indued with manhode wysdome and ryches
Ouer the comons hauynge the soueraynte
Correcte them whiche so do tere me
By cruell othes without repentaunce
Amende be tyme lest I take vengeance

Exodi vicesimo / non accipies nomen dei tui in vānum

Vnto the man I gaue commaundement
Not to take the name of thy god vaynfully
As not to swere but at tyme conuenyent
Before a Iuge to bere recorde truely
Namyng my name with reuerence mekely
Vnto the Iuge than there in presence
By my name to gyue to the good credence

A my brederne yf that I be wrothe
It is for cause ye falsly by me swere
Ye knowe yourselfe that I am very trothe
Bet wrongfully ye do me rente and tere
ye neyther loue me nor my lustyce fere
And yf ye dyde ye wolde full gentylly
Obeye my byddyng well and perfytely

The worldly kynges hauynge the soueraynte
ye do well obey without resystence
ye dare not take theyr names in vanyte
But with grete honoure and eke reuerence
Than my name more hye of magnyfycence
ye ought more to drede whiche am kynge of all
Bothe god and man and reygne celestyall

No erthely man loueth you so well
As I do / which mekely dyde enclyne
For to redeme you from the fendes of hell
Takyng your kynde by my godhede dyuyne
you were the fendes I dyde make you myne
For you swete bretherne I was on the rode
Gyuyng my body my herte and my blode

Than why do ye in euery maner of place
With cruell othes tere my body and herte
My sydes and woundes it is a pyteous cace
Alas swete brederne I wolde you conuerte
For to take vengeaunce ye do me coherte
From the hous of swerers shall not be absent
The plage of Iustyce to take punysshement

¶Vnde. Ecclesiastici .xxxiii. Vir multum iurans implebitur iniquitate et non discedet a domo eius plaga.

A man moche swerynge with grete iniquite
Shall be replete and from his mancyon
The plage of vengeaunce shall not cessed be
Wherefore ye brederne full of abusyon
Take ye good hede to this dyscrypcyon
Come now to me and axe forgyuenes
And be penytente and haue it douteles

Augustinus. Non potest male mori qui bene vixit et vix bene moritur q^{ui} male vixit.

Who in this worlde lyueth well and ryghtwysly
Sall deye well by ryght good knowlegynge
Who in this worlde lyueth yll and wrongfully
Shall hardly scape to haue good endynge
I do graunte mercy but no tyme enlongynge
Wherefore good brederne whyles that ye haue space
Amend your lyfe and come vnto my grace

My wordes my prelates vnto you do preche
For to conuerte you from your wretchednes
But lytell auaylleth you nowe for to teche
The worlde hathe cast you in such blyndnes
Lyke vnto stones your hertes hathe hardnes
That my swete wordes may not reconsyle
Your hertes harde with mortall synne so vyle

Wo worthe your hertes so planted in pryde
Wo worthe your wrath and mortall enuye
Wo worthe slouth that dothe with you abyde
Wo worthe also inmesurable glotony
Wo worthe your tedyus synne of lechery
Wo worthe you whome I gaue free wyll
Wo worthe couetyse that dothe your souse spyll

Wo worthe shorte Ioye cause of payne eternall
Wo worthe you that be so peruerted
Wo worthe your pleasures in the synnes mortall
Wo worthe you for whome I sore smerted
Wo worthe you euer but ye be conuerted
Wo worthe you whose makynge I repente
Wo worthe your horryble synne so vyolent

Wo worthe you whiche do me forsake
Wo worthe you whiche wylllyngely offende
Wo worthe your swerynge whiche dothe not aslake
Wo worthe you whiche wyll nothyng amende
Wo worthe vyce that dothe on you attende

Wo worthe your grete vnkyndenes to me
Wo worthe your hertes withouten pyte

Wo worthe your falshode and your doublenesse
Wo worthe also your corrupte Iugement
Wo worthe delyte in worldely rychesse
Wo worthe bebate without extynguyshment
Wo worthe your wordes so moche impacient
Wo worthe you vnto whome I dyde bote
And wo worthe you that tere me at the rote

Blessyd be ye that loue humylyte
Blessyd be ye that loue trouthe and pacyence
Blessyd be ye folowynges werkes of equitye
Blessyd be ye that loue well abstynence
Blessyd be ye vyrgyns of excellence
Blessyd be ye which loue well vertue
Blessyd be ye whiche do the worlde eschue

Blessyd be ye that heuenly Ioye do loue
Blessyd be ye in vertuous gouernaunce
Blessyd be ye whiche do pleasures reproue
Blessyd be ye that consyder my greuaunce
Blessyd be ye whiche do take repentaunce
Blessyd be ye remembryng my passyon
Blessyd be ye makynge petycyon

Blessyd be ye folowyng my trace
Blessyd be ye louynge trybulacyon
Blessyd be ye not wyllynge to trespace
Blessyd be ye of my castycacyon
Blessyd be ye of good operacyon
Blessyd be ye vnto me ryght kynde
Blessyd be you whiche haue me in your mynde

Blessyd be ye leuyng yll company
Blessyd be ye hauntyng the vertuous

Blessyd be ye that my name magnefy
Blessyd be ye techynge the vycyous
Blessyd be ye good and relygyous
Blessyd be ye in the lyfe temperall
Whiche applye yourselfe to Ioye celestyall

The brytyll worlde ryght often transmutable
Who wyll in it his lyfe in tyme well spende
Shall Ioye attayne after inestymable
For in the worlde he must fyrst condyscende.
To take grete payne as his power wyll extende
Agaynst the worlde the flesshe and the deuyll
By my grete grace for to withstande theyr euyll

For who can be a gretter fole than he
That spendeth his tyme to hym vncertayne
For a breuyat pleasure of worldly vanyte
Than after that to haue eternall payne
Who of the worlde delyteth and is fayne
Shall after sorowe and cry ve ve
In an other worlde quante sunt tenebre

Who is wyser than he that wyll applye
In the worlde to take payne by due dylygence
After shorte payne to come to grete glorye
Whiche is eterne moost hye of excellence
Where he shall se my grete magnyfycence
With many aungelles whiche for theyr solace
Insacyately do beholde my face

Regarde no Ioye of the erthly consystory
For lyke as Phebus dothe the snowe relente
So passeth the Ioyes of the worlde transytory
Tyme renneth fast tyll worldly lyfe be spent
Consyder this in your entendemente
Blessed be they that my worde do here
And kepe it well, for they are to me dere

Therefore good brederne your hertes enclyne
To loue and drede me that am omnipotent
Bothe god and man in Ioye celestyne
Beholde my body all to torne and rente
With your spytefull othes cruell and vyolent
I loue you ye hate me ye are to harde herted
I helpe you ye tere me lo how for you I smerted

Mercy and peace dyde make an vnyte
Bytwene you and me but trouthe & ryghtwysnesse
Do nowe complayne byddyng my godheed se
How that ye breke the lege of sothfastnesse
They tell me that by Iustyce doubtelesse
I must take vengeaunce vpon you sykerly
That by your swerynge, agayne me crucefye

For at the request of good mercy and peace
I haue forborne you longe and many a daye
Bet more and more your synnes do encrease
Wherefore my Iustyce wyll no more delaye
But take vengeaunce for all your proude araye
I warne you ofte ye are nothyng the better
But ye amende my vengenaunce shall be gretter

¶ Contra iuratores chr^{isti} in celo crucifigentes. per bernardū dicit dominus. Nonne satis pro te vulneratus sum? nonne satis pro te afflictus sum? desine amplius peccare. q^{uia} magis aggrauat vulnus peccati q^{uam} vulnus lateris mei.

Am not I wounded for the suffycyent
Haue I not for the ynoughe afflyccyon
Leue more to synne by good amendement
The wounde of synne to me is more passyon
Than the wounde of my syde for thy redempcyon
Thoughe I do spare I shall you desteny
But ye amende to brenne eternally

With my bloody woundes I dyde your chartre seale

Why do you tere it / why do ye breke it so
Syth it to you is the eternall heale
And the releace of euerlastynge wo
Beholde this lettre with the prynte also
Of myn owne seale by perfyte portrature
Prynte it in mynde and ye shall helthe recure

And ye kynges and lordes of renowne
Exorte your seruauntes theyr swerynge to cease
Come vnto me and cast your synne adowne
And I my vengeaunce shall truely releace
With grace and plente / I shall you encrace
And brynge you whiche reuolue inwardly
This is my complaynte to eternall glory.

AMEN.

¶The Auctour as foloweth.

¶Go lytell treatyse deuoyde of eloquence
Tremblynge for dreade to approche the maieste
Of our souereynge lord surmountynge in excellence
Put under the wyng of his benygnyte
Submyttyng the to his mercyfull pytie.
And beseche hys grace to pardon thy rudnesse
Whych of late was made to eschewe ydlenesse.

¶Thus endeth the conuersyon of swerers, made and compyled by Stephen Hawys, groome of the chambre of our souerigne lorde Kyng Henry the seuenth. Enprynted at London, in Fletestrete, at the sygne of the Sonne, by Wynken de Worde, Prynter vnto the moost excellent prynses, my lady the kynges graundame, the yere of our Lord a MCCCCCIX. the first yere of the reigne of our souerayne lord kyng Henry the VIII.



Notes on the Text

Capital **U/V** is shown as “V” for consistency, although the letterform is closer to “U”. Thorn **Þ** appears several times at the beginning of lines, and once in an abbreviation; “th” is used everywhere else. A series of lines on page A.iii. verso, starting with “ye neyther loue me nor my lustyce fere”, have initial lower-case “y”. The first of these may have been necessary to avoid collision with the **Þ** of the previous line:

**Ye knowe yourselfe that I am very trothe
 Þet wrongfully pe do me rente and tere
 ye neyther loue me noꝝ my Iustyce fere**

In verse, nasal abbreviations such as **ã** and **ẽ** appear only in lines with large initial drop caps. Other abbreviations—mainly in the Latin passages—are shown in this e-

text as superscripts: **q^{ui}**, **chr^{isti}**. The word shown as **p^{ou}** was printed as **u** directly above **p**: **p̄**. Not all browsers can display this form correctly.

Thumbnail view of **Page A.iii. verso** (entire page):



See
 are chynde
 Be
 Agayne
 My payne In mynde
 Ketyne
 My swete bloode
 On the roode my byder
 Wyde the good
 My face ryght red
 Myn armes spred chynke none oder
 My woundes bled
 Scholde thou my syde
 Wounded so ryght wyde call for thyne othere lase
 Wiedynge soe that tyde
 Thus for the flattered
 Thy arte þ harde herted & thy swerynge aslake
 Be by me conuerted
 Cete me nowe no more
 My woundes are soe and come to my grace
 Leue swerynge therfore
 I am redy
 To graunte mercy for thy trespase
 To the truly
 Come nowe nere
 My frende dere befoze me
 And appere
 I lo
 In wo le la
 Wyde go
 E

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE
CONUERCYON OF SWERERS ***

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